

GREED

EXAMINED

Really cool products come to the Digit Test Centre which don't really fit into the standard product categories that we review in the Bazaar section. We write about them here mostly to make you turn green with envy.

Merlin Digital Futureboard

Last month, we had the pleasure of drifting around the neighbourhood on a self-balancing board from IO Walk. Using different names, there are numerous other retailers who are repackaging and selling these boards in the country. No, we aren't going to call them hoverboards because they don't hover. Merlin Digital sent down their Futureboard at our labs and we wasted no time in beginning our shenanigans with the board. It wasn't a high end version like the IO Walk

Elite but rather a more entry level one. One distinct feature that made this Futureboard stand out is the bluetooth speaker embedded in the chassis. You can connect your smartphone and play your favourite songs.

The material on this doesn't seem as sturdy as the previous board we'd got, but that didn't stop us from zooming around on the terrace at high speeds. The board had better precision compared to the IO Walk



and even slight maneuvers would turn the board in the particular direction. Moving around obstacles seemed easier with the Merlin Futureboard. The trade off was that it wasn't as stable and we found it difficult to maintain a straight path. It would wobble at high speeds. The Futureboard has a top speed of 10 kmph. On paper it may seem less but when you're drifting on the board, even 5 kmph seems fast. It takes around 2-3 hours to fully charge the device and it should be able to travel a distance of 20 km in one single charge. We extensively used the Futureboard for menial tasks such as getting coffee and even passing a sheet of paper from one end of the office to the other. Walking is so 2015 right?

Apart from a few niggles about build quality and stability issues, the Futureboard is still fun. At a price of ₹35,000 many of us kept looking at it longingly. Some of the more adventurous in our midst were actually considering buying it.

Henne BMW Landspeeder

Reviving a legend

Ok first off unlike the self balancing board you see above, this beauty didn't actually grace us with a visit. We wish it had but this is as good a section as any to write about it. Texan shop Revival Cycles has built the custom-designed Henne BMW Landspeeder to pay homage to a bygone era when motorcycles were works of art. Accented with vintage aesthetics, it wouldn't be a surprise if the bike is still a rage in the future. More than the technology used in the bike, the experience of riding it is of utmost importance according to the makers. Based on the original design of Ernst Henne's original landspeeder design, the 1928 BMW R37, this elegant work of craftsmanship is completely hand-made. The original design zoomed past



more than 76 land speed world records between 1929 and 1937. To bring it back to life in this age, the Revival Cycles team spent more than a month working on the aluminium bodywork and were finally able to revive the legendary bike. The vehicle has been adorned with

several hand-fabricated parts and a lot of time has been spent on perfecting all the details. Not exactly falling short on the embedded technology, additional improvements include increased stability for high-speeds but sadly you won't be breaking any records on this age old bike. The bodywork has been overhauled with customised stainless steel hardware and a lengthened steel body while the front suspension now has a 24 degree setup. Bike lovers will surely appreciate the

intricate design of the Henne BMW Landspeeder and it's difficult to break it to you but this dream machine isn't for sale, no matter how rich and influential you are. It was apparently made on request of a client who wanted to have it just for display. Massive bummer right?